

SPaG, Comprehension & Maths — QE Barnet Recap

Exam in 2 days (QE Barnet — English & Maths papers, no VR). Use as a rapid-fire "have we covered this" checklist, not a worksheet.

1 · SPAG (SPELLING, PUNCTUATION & GRAMMAR)

Spelling

- ☐ Homophones (there/their/they're, its/it's, your/you're)
- ☐ Common 11+ trap words (necessary, definitely, separate, accommodate)
- ☐ Plurals of tricky nouns (-ies, -ves, irregular)
- ☐ Prefixes/suffixes changing meaning (un-, dis-, -able, -ible)

Punctuation

- ☐ Apostrophes: contraction vs. possession, joint possession
- ☐ Comma splices — spot and fix
- ☐ Semicolon vs. comma vs. full stop
- ☐ Quotation marks around reported/direct speech
- ☐ Hyphenation in compound modifiers

Grammar

- ☐ Subject–verb agreement (tricky collective nouns)
- ☐ Tense consistency across a passage
- ☐ Correct relative pronoun (who/which/that)
- ☐ "Find the mistake" segment format — practise under time

Cloze **C·L·O·Z·E**

Cloze = fill-the-gap passage. One missing word per numbered blank.

- ☐ Read the WHOLE sentence (before + after the gap) before choosing
- ☐ Check the word fits grammatically, not just sense
- ☐ Watch for connective/linking words (although, whereas, since)
- ☐ Re-read the finished sentence to confirm it flows

2 · COMPREHENSION

Core technique

- ☐ Skim first for overall gist, then scan for detail per question
- ☐ Underline key nouns/names as you read
- ☐ Answer using the passage's own evidence, not outside knowledge
- ☐ Watch for "NOT true / NOT mentioned" questions — read every option
- ☐ Retrieval questions: find the exact matching detail, watch for near-identical decoys

Inference techniques

- ☐ "What does this suggest about X?" → find evidence, don't guess
- ☐ Combine clues from more than one paragraph
- ☐ Character/author "voice" questions — what word would they use?
- ☐ Don't over-read — the safest inference is the one closest to the text

Literary techniques to recognise

- ☐ Simile / Metaphor
- ☐ Personification
- ☐ Alliteration / Onomatopoeia
- ☐ Imagery (visual, sound, touch)
- ☐ Hyperbole
- ☐ Foreshadowing
- ☐ Repetition for emphasis

3 · THREE LAYERS — CHARACTER & SETTING

Character (3 layers)

- ☐ **Physical** — appearance, what we see
- ☐ **Emotional** — feelings, inner thoughts
- ☐ **Behavioural** — actions, what they do/say

Setting (3 layers)

- ☐ **Physical** — what's there, concrete detail
- ☐ **Sensory / Imagery** — sounds, smells, textures
- ☐ **Atmosphere / Mood** — how it makes the reader feel

Show, Not Tell

- ☐ Replace a flat statement ("she was sad") with action/sensory detail (her hands trembled, she looked away)
- ☐ Use one character/setting layer at a time to build up description, don't dump all three at once

4 · MATHS — QUICK RECAP

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| ☐ Arithmetic: BIDMAS, negative numbers, rounding | ☐ Algebra: solving simple equations, substitution |
| ☐ Fractions/decimals/percentages: converting between, percentage increase/decrease | ☐ Geometry: angles (point/triangle), area/perimeter |
| ☐ Ratio & proportion: simplifying, sharing in a ratio | ☐ Statistics: mean/median/range, reading charts |